

BATNA, preparation and mandating

Day 3 · Session 2 | Both sectors | Shared resource

FICTIONAL TRAINING EXERCISE. Use only your assigned role. A role label separates downloads for the exercise; files on this public website are accessible to anyone with the link.

Keep this preparation worksheet. Job Grading shared facts and each team's brief are separate downloads; open only the brief for your assigned side.

BATNA — Quick Reference

Your Best Alternative To a Negotiated Agreement: what you will actually do if this negotiation ends without a deal. Not your opening position, not your walk-away number — your genuine next-best course of action.

Key aspect	Detail
Know your own BATNA	Work it out in preparation, not mid-negotiation under pressure
Estimate the other side's	Their power comes from it, whether or not you can see it clearly
Improve it actively	Treat your BATNA as something you can strengthen, not a fixed fact
Never reveal a weak one	But never bluff a strong one you don't have — a called bluff costs credibility
Compare offers against it	Not against your original opening position

Clarifying Objectives, Priorities, Limits and Trade-offs

Complete this before you receive your Job Grading brief. It applies to any negotiation you prepare for, this week and afterward.

Prompt	Your notes
Our objective(s), ranked by priority	
Our genuine limits — our walk-away point	
Possible trade-offs we could offer	
What we would want in return for each trade-off	

Mandating — Do and Don't

Do	Don't
Secure a mandate with clear boundaries but genuine room for judgment Agree a realistic check-in process before negotiations start Manage your constituency's expectations honestly throughout Debrief your constituency promptly and honestly afterward	Accept a mandate so rigid it leaves no room to explore options Overpromise to sound strong, then have to walk it back Use "checking with my principal" as a stalling tactic Wait until signing to discover your mandate didn't cover it

Job Grading — Team Preparation Worksheet

Complete this after your team receives its brief. The role-play launches in Wednesday Session 2 (11:00); you negotiate in Session 3 (14:00).

Prompt	Our team's answer
Our actual interests (not just our position)	
Our opening position	
Our walk-away point	
What we think the other side's underlying interests might be	
One question we will ask the other side early in the negotiation	